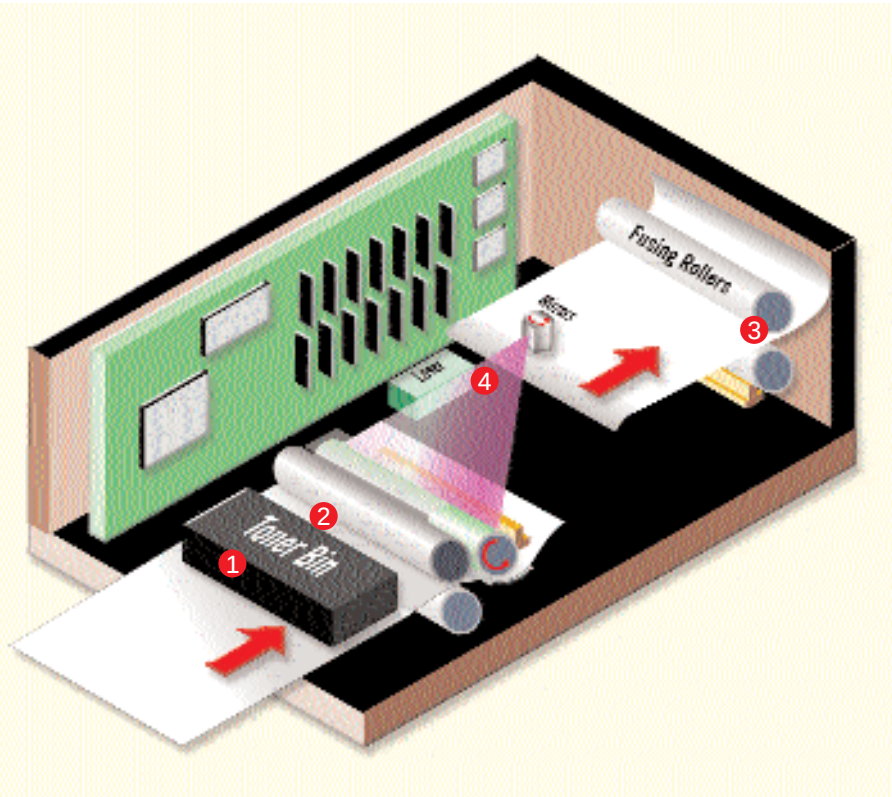




Do Remember

- Laser printers are often used as shared resources in an office, hence networking capabilities and a sizeable buffer memory—a minimum of 8 MB—makes all the difference.
- If the printing load at your office is high, opt for a printer that has a paper input tray capacity of more than 500 pages.
- Before buying a laser printer, check and validate the speed (rated in ppm) and the cost per page. Smaller laser printers cost less, but return a higher cost per page. A full-fledged laser printer may cost upwards of Rs 30,000, but works out cheaper in the long run.

Facts

- An A4-size page has 33 million dots at a resolution of 600 dpi.
- Prices of laser printers have dropped considerably over the last couple of years. Entry-level printers cost just Rs 10,000.



The Future

As of now, though inkjet printers rule the roost when it comes to photo-quality printing, the future lies in laser printers.

Not too long ago, laser printers were way too expensive for the average SoHo user. Despite the long-term benefits and convenience, the price used to be a stumbling block.

However, the past few months have seen a sharp drop in prices. Moreover, a wide range of features such as networking capabilities, storage and paper management, which cater to various kinds of users, have been built into laser printers.



Buying Tips

- ✓ **WARRANTY:** The warranty should be comprehensive and on-site. A carry-in warranty is bad, as it might entail carrying the printer to a service centre.
- ✓ **QUALITY OR PRICE?** Faster and high-quality printers are costlier than their slower counterparts. If you're in no hurry to take your printouts, or don't need excellent quality, set your sights a little lower. You'll end up saving a lot of money that way.
- ✓ **AFTER-SALES SERVICE:** It's irritating when expensive peripherals crash or malfunction. Add lousy customer service, and you'll be ready to throw it out the window. Ask people who've already bought printers about their experiences with customer-support staff. This involves some serious questioning, but it's better than having to question your choice later on.

- ① **Toner Bin:** This stores the toner, which is responsible for forming the image.
- ② **Drum:** The drum is the heart of a laser printer; it stores the image to be printed in the form of an electrostatic charge. The charged areas of the drum pick up ink from the toner, and then the drum rolls over the paper to form the image or text.
- ③ **Fusing Roller:** The fusing roller applies heat and pressure to the paper, so that the image formed by the drum becomes permanent.
- ④ **Mirror and Laser:** The mirror and the laser convert digital data to electrostatic charge on the drum.

Quick Find	
YOU NEED	Cheap, average quality, and decent-speed printing
Basic Use	
LOOK FOR	An A4 printer with a resolution of 600 x 1,200 dpi
YOU NEED	Fast and high-quality printing, cost not being a criterion
Inter Use	
LOOK FOR	Resolution of 1,200 x 1,200 dpi, and ability to handle larger print loads